

FACT FILE

- » **Weight:** 77 lbs (35 kg)
- » **Function:** To solve math equations
- » **Speed:** 30–60 seconds for calculations involving four-digit numbers
- » **Hardware:** Keyboard with 37 keys, printer, and plastic shell with the central processing unit inside

Programma 101

In 1965, the Italian company, Olivetti, made history by creating the world's first personal desktop computer, Programma 101. This groundbreaking piece of technology was designed to work out complicated math calculations. It was easy to use and could fit comfortably on a desk.

The blue light meant the machine was running and ready for input, while the red light indicated an error.



The Programma 101 could print 30 characters (numbers, letters, or symbols) per second.

The keyboard featured three switches used to run programs, record data, and print results.

Then and now

Computers have changed a lot over the years. Early computers were large enough to fill whole rooms, but modern computers are small enough to fit into a backpack. By the 1960s, people were able to buy their own personal computer for their home.